

Literature • Fantasy

Grade	1	Word Count	331
Lexile	480L	Multi-level	J N S
Learning A–Z	level J		

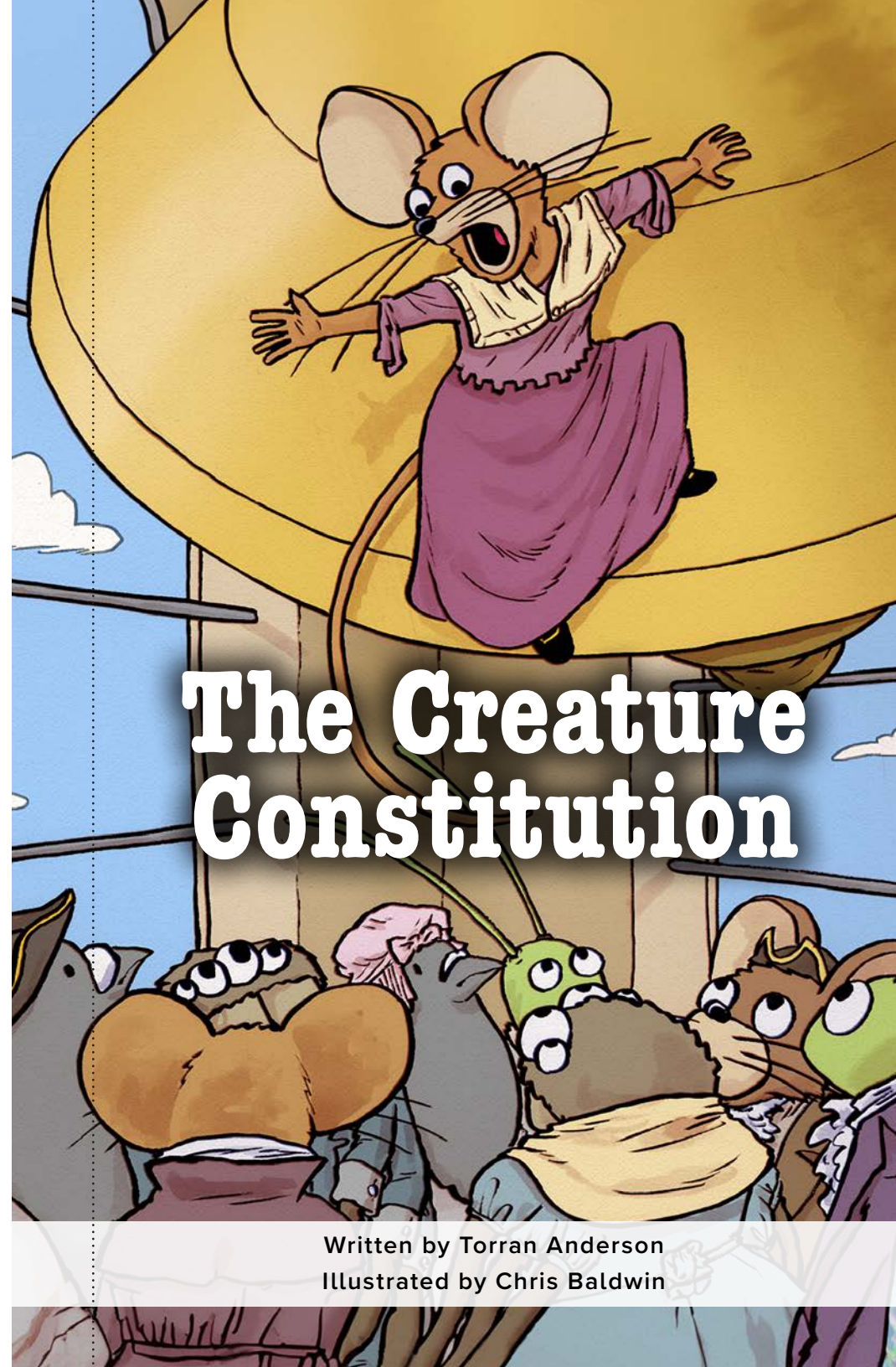
Refer to the Focus Question on page 2 of this title to guide discussion and support additional learning connected to the text.

The Creature Constitution is the story of Maddy the Mouse and the other animal residents of Independence Hall in 1786. Some animal are miserable and tired because singing pigeons, scurrying mice, and chirping crickets make it hard for anyone to sleep. Follow along as Maddy brings the creatures together to create a constitution that will improve life for all of them.

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The Creature Constitution

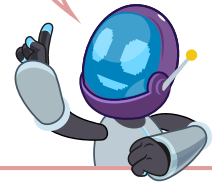
Written by Torran Anderson
Illustrated by Chris Baldwin

The Creature Constitution



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Focus Question
Why are constitutions
created?



Words to Know

agreed	rules
argue	signed
constitution	tired

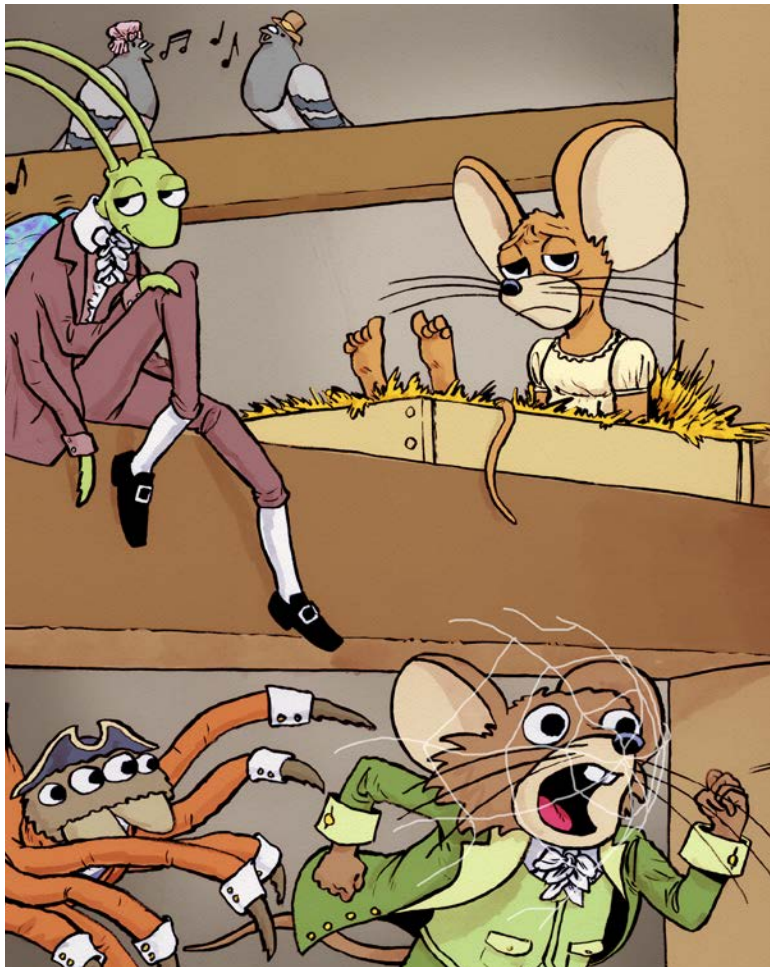


Independence Hall Philadelphia, 1786

None of the creatures in the hall were able to sleep.
Every night, the mice would run through the spiders' webs.
Then the spiders would chase the mice.



The crickets would chirp all night.
The pigeons in the clock tower would start singing early in the morning.
Everyone was **tired** and unhappy.



Maddy the Mouse had the biggest ears in the hall.
She heard everything.
She worried that no one would ever sleep.



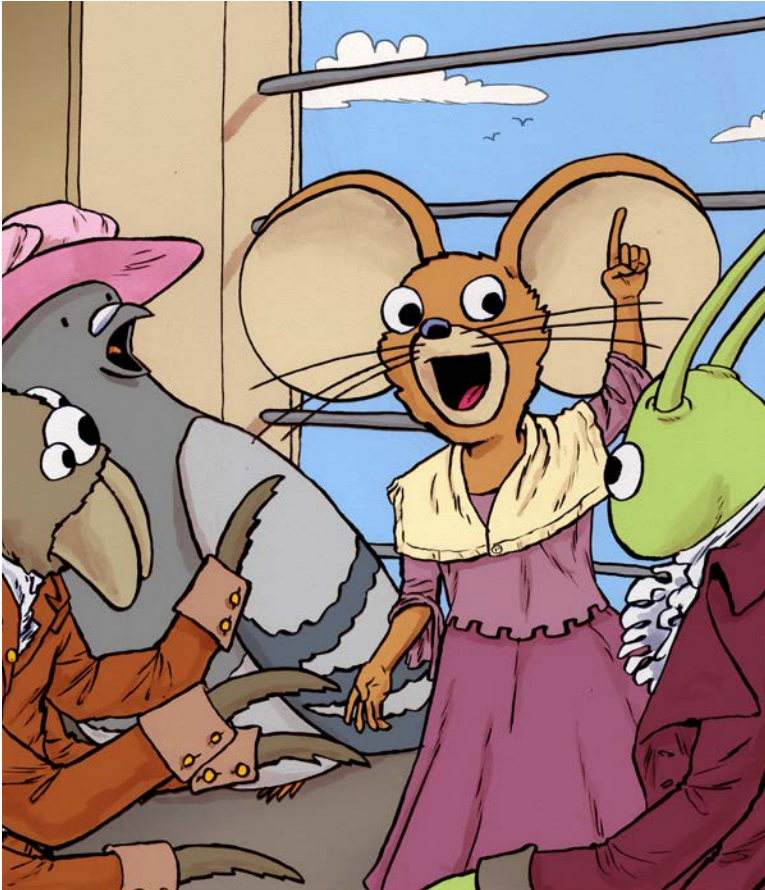
Then the humans began meeting in the hall.
Maddy sneaked into the room and listened as they talked.
They needed something with **rules** that everyone would follow.
They called it a **constitution**.



Maddy thought a constitution
was a great idea.
She called a meeting.
Every creature came.
There were so many animals
that they could barely move.



“The humans have a great idea,”
Maddy said.
“They are writing a constitution.
We should have our own
constitution.”



“What’s a constitution?” asked a pigeon.

“It’s a list of rules for us to live by,” Maddy said.

“We need rules so we can all sleep.”

All the creatures **agreed**.



“There are too many of us to talk about the rules right now,” Maddy said.

“Each group should pick five creatures to talk for them at a meeting tomorrow. They will decide what the new rules will be.”



The groups each went back to where they lived. They picked animals to speak for their group.



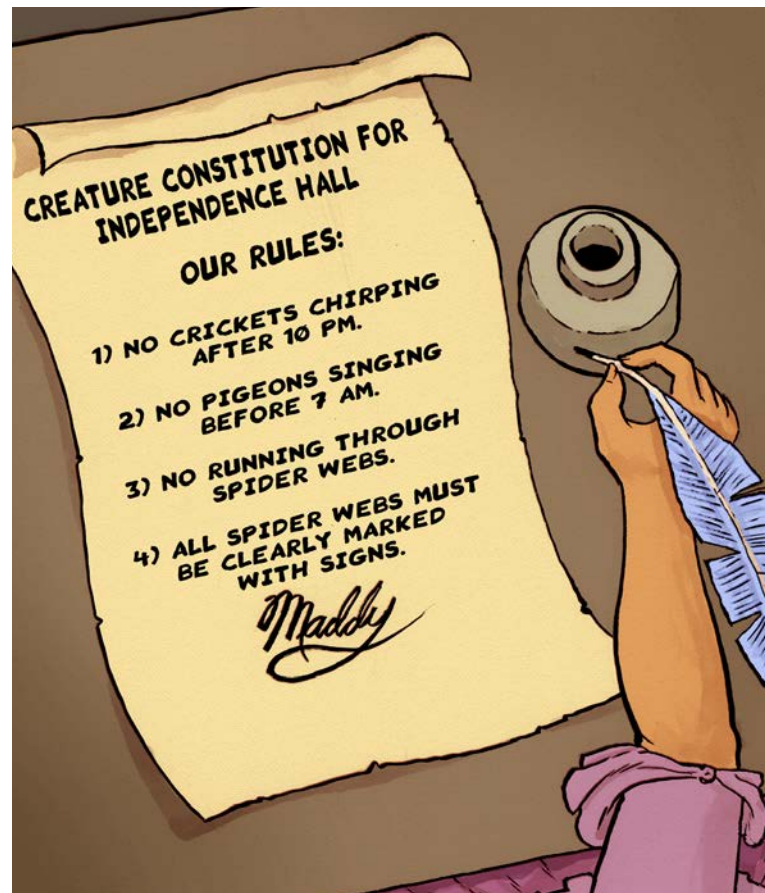
The next day, the chosen creatures met. Everyone listened to each other's problems.



When the groups started to **argue**, Maddy reminded them to work together.

Each group then shared the rules that they thought would let everyone sleep better.

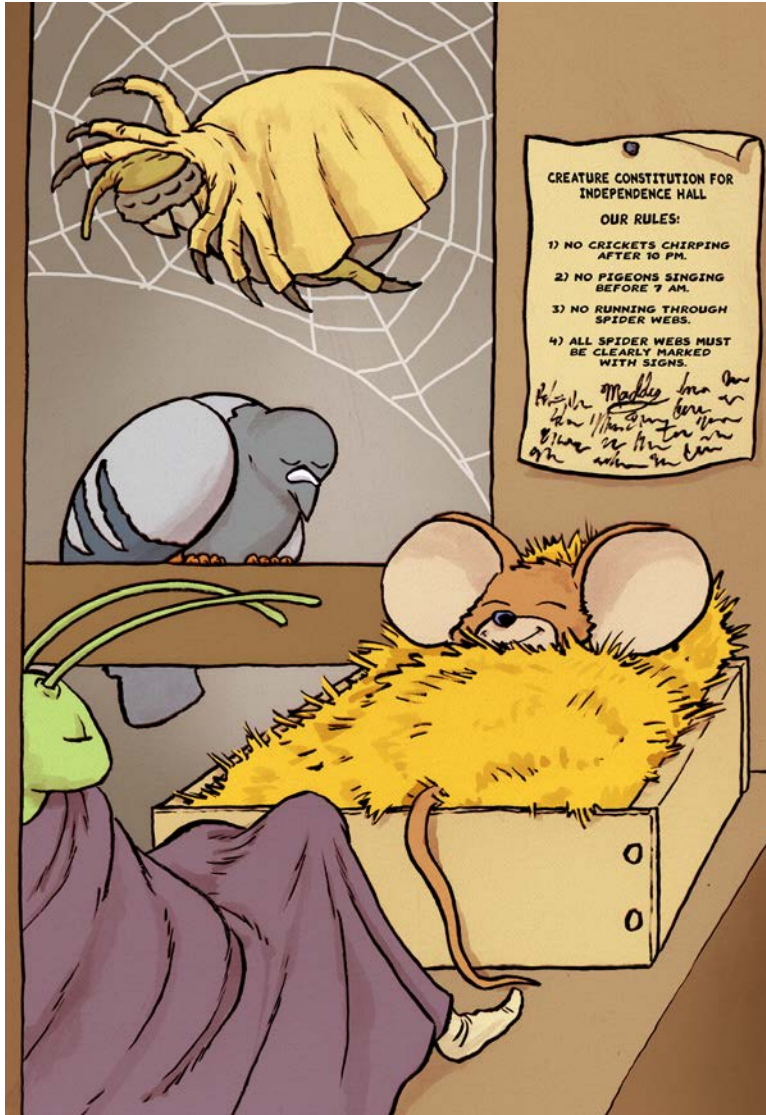
They came up with rules that everyone could agree on.



Maddy had found a way for them to all work together.

The creatures asked Maddy to be their leader.

They would bring new problems to Maddy and the other groups.



The night they **signed** their constitution, the creatures in the building all had a good night's sleep.

Glossary

agreed (v.) page 9

to have the same opinion

argue (v.) page 13

to disagree; to give reasons for or against something

constitution (n.) page 6

the basic laws of a state or nation that tell how the government is run

rules (n.) page 6

things that tell what is or is not allowed

signed (v.) page 15

wrote one's name on something

tired (adj.) page 4

in need of rest or sleep